PRACTICE EXAM 27 / EXAM SET 04

Domain 6: Communication and Customer Service

12 scored questions	4 answer choices per question	Answer key + explanations included

Instructions

Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. Mark your responses before checking the answer key and detailed explanations at the end of this document. These practice questions are not official NHA examination items.

QUESTIONS

Q01 | Patient-Centered Communication

SCENARIO During intake, a patient says that their old knee concern has improved, that a new shoulder concern is the reason for today's visit, and that they would also like the provider to discuss a work form. The assistant has listened without interruption and wants to verify the summary before relaying it.

Which statement best summarizes the patient's stated agenda and checks its accuracy?

A. "Your knee concern has improved, so I will tell the provider that your earlier problem is resolved."

B. "You have a shoulder concern and a work form, so I will ask the provider to address the form first."

C. "Your shoulder is today's main concern, and you also want to discuss a work form. Have I understood correctly?"

D. "You mentioned several concerns, so I will tell the provider that all of them need the same amount of time."

Q02 | Accessible and Inclusive Communication

SCENARIO A patient is completing intake with a qualified interpreter who understands the patient's language. The assistant asks several long questions before pausing. The interpreter asks for shorter segments so each message can be interpreted fully. Clinic guidance directs staff to use short, complete statements and allow interpretation before continuing.

Which adjustment best follows this guidance?

A. Ask one short, complete question and pause for interpretation and the patient's response.

B. Read the full question list first so the interpreter can organize the entire interview before replying.

C. Ask the same long questions more loudly so the interpreter can retain the important medical terms.

D. Ask the interpreter to shorten the patient's answers so the assistant can complete the interview faster.

Q03 | Teamwork Conflict and Professionalism

SCENARIO A new coworker has begun introducing themself and explaining their role before each intake. A medical assistant observes that patients who had been unsure who was speaking to them now begin the intake more comfortably. The assistant wants to reinforce the useful behavior with constructive positive feedback.

Which statement gives the most specific, useful feedback?

A. "You are a natural with patients. I wish everyone on the team had your personality."

B. "The supervisor should know that you are doing a good job; I will mention it sometime."

C. "Patients seem happier today. Whatever you are doing differently must be helping the clinic."

D. "Explaining your name and role helped patients know who was assisting them. Please keep using that introduction."

Q04 | Telephone Written and Virtual Communication

SCENARIO During a verified telephone call, a patient says, "I felt feverish last night, but I did not take my temperature. I would like the nurse to call me." The assistant confirms the callback number. Under clinic workflow, the assistant will relay this report to the nurse rather than characterize the patient's condition independently.

Which message accurately separates the patient's report from a measured finding?

A. The patient had a documented fever last night and requests a nurse callback at the verified number.

B. The patient was unable to confirm fever, so no temperature-related symptoms were reported during the call.

C. The patient reports feeling feverish last night; no temperature was measured. The patient requests a nurse callback.

D. The patient's temperature was probably elevated last night but returned to normal before the telephone call.

Q05 | Patient-Centered Communication

SCENARIO A patient waiting to discuss a biopsy report says to the medical assistant, "I am frightened. Can you tell me this definitely is not cancer?" The provider has not yet discussed the report with the patient. The assistant is not authorized to interpret its clinical significance.

Which response best acknowledges the fear while remaining accurate and within the assistant's role?

A. "I can tell this is worrying. The provider can explain the report; I will let them know you want to talk."

B. "Most reports are less serious than they sound, so you can assume this is probably reassuring until the provider arrives."

C. "If the office did not call immediately, the report cannot be serious; the provider will confirm that when they come in."

D. "I have seen reports like this before, so I can explain what it means while you wait for the provider to arrive."

Q06 | Telephone Written and Virtual Communication

SCENARIO Before a scheduled virtual visit, a patient phones the clinic and says, "I opened something on my phone, but I do not see a button to join." The patient has not yet connected to the visit. The assistant has approved setup guides for both the clinic app and the website, which display different controls.

Which response best establishes the information needed to provide useful setup help?

A. "Look for a camera symbol and tap it; most phones use the same controls for joining a visit."

B. "Are you in the clinic app or a web browser, and what words or buttons do you see now?"

C. "Close everything and reinstall the clinic app first; that should make the join button appear on your screen."

D. "Keep tapping the screen until the visit opens, and call us again if the provider does not appear."

Q07 | Accessible and Inclusive Communication

SCENARIO River, who uses they/them pronouns, says that repeated announcements and bright lights in the waiting area make it hard for them to follow conversation. They request a quieter place with less intense lighting. An approved waiting room with those features is available, and staff can notify River there when the visit begins.

Which action best responds to River's stated communication needs?

A. Offer the quieter room and explain how staff will let River know when it is time for the visit.

B. Keep River in the main area and repeat each statement at greater volume so it competes with the announcements.

C. Offer earplugs in the main area and rely on the overhead announcement to notify River that the visit is beginning.

D. Ask River to wait outside the building and return periodically to check whether staff have called for them.

Q08 | Teamwork Conflict and Professionalism

SCENARIO A medical assistant realizes that they directed a patient to the wrong room. The patient has returned and says, "I went where you told me, and now I have to start over." The correct room has been confirmed, and the assistant can personally guide the patient there.

Which response best acknowledges the service error and provides a concrete remedy?

A. "I am sorry you had trouble. The room numbers confuse many people, so please check the signs again on your way."

B. "Someone must have changed the room assignment. Please go back down the hallway and ask another staff member to confirm it."

C. "I am sorry I gave you the wrong directions. I have confirmed the correct room and can walk there with you now."

D. "At least you found your way back. Let me repeat the directions more slowly so you will not need additional help today."

Q09 | Telephone Written and Virtual Communication

> **SCENARIO** A medical assistant is preparing a written appointment reminder that may be read several days after it is sent. The confirmed in-person appointment is Tuesday, November 17, 2026, at 2:00 p.m. Eastern Time at the clinic's Pine Street office. The draft currently says, "See you next Tuesday afternoon at our usual office."

Which replacement best avoids ambiguity about time and place?

A. "Your visit is next Tuesday at two in the afternoon at the office where you usually see us."
B. "Your visit is on November 17 at the regular afternoon time at the Pine Street office."
C. "Your visit is Tuesday afternoon in Eastern Time; please come to our usual office at the scheduled hour."
D. "Your visit is Tuesday, November 17, 2026, at 2:00 p.m. Eastern Time at our Pine Street office."

Q10 | Patient-Centered Communication

> **SCENARIO** A patient ready for a routine intake says, "Before we begin, I would like a few minutes for a brief prayer." There is no urgent concern. Clinic workflow allows a short pause with the team informed, and the patient is already in a private room.

Which response best respects the individual request while coordinating the visit?

A. "We can continue asking questions while you pray so that your visit stays on schedule."
B. "We can pause for a few minutes. I will let the team know and check back with you shortly."
C. "I will tell the provider that you are not ready for medical care and need a different appointment."
D. "Please explain your religious tradition first so I can decide whether a pause is appropriate today."

Q11 | Accessible and Inclusive Communication

> **SCENARIO** A patient who is blind tells the medical assistant, "Please tell me when you leave the room and when someone comes in, so I know who is here." The patient is seated safely and waiting for the provider. The assistant needs to step out briefly to notify the provider that intake is complete.

Which statement best supports the patient's requested awareness of who is present?

A. "I have finished intake. You should be able to hear from the door when someone arrives."
B. "I am stepping out now to notify the provider. I will identify myself when I return."
C. "I will leave the door open so you can use hallway conversations to work out who is nearby."
D. "I will ask the next person to wave before entering so you know that your visit is continuing."

Q12 | Teamwork Conflict and Professionalism

SCENARIO During a nonurgent service call, a caller repeatedly directs sexual comments at a medical assistant. The assistant has already stated that the comments must stop and that the call will end if they continue. The caller continues. Clinic policy directs staff to end such calls after that warning, record the incident objectively, and notify the supervisor, who arranges an appropriate route for any unresolved service request.

Which action best follows the stated policy and maintains a professional boundary?

A. Continue the call to avoid a complaint and leave the sexual comments out of the service record.

B. Transfer the caller to another assistant without explanation so the original assistant no longer has to respond.

C. Respond with a personal insult to establish a firm boundary and then continue handling the service request.

D. State that the call is ending, disconnect, document the behavior objectively, and notify the supervisor.

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

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01 C	02 A	03 D	04 C	05 A	06 B
07 A	08 C	09 D	10 B	11 B	12 D

DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

Q01 | Correct answer: C

"Your shoulder is today's main concern, and you also want to discuss a work form. Have I understood correctly?"

The summary retains the patient's stated main concern and additional request, then invites confirmation. It does not turn improvement into resolution or impose a different order on the visit. Summarizing is useful after listening because it lets the patient correct omissions before information is passed along.

Q02 | Correct answer: A

Ask one short, complete question and pause for interpretation and the patient's response.

Short, complete questions followed by time for interpretation support a full two-way exchange under the stated guidance. The language match is adequate; the problem is the amount of information presented before a pause. Greater volume or compressed summaries do not address that problem.

Q03 | Correct answer: D

"Explaining your name and role helped patients know who was assisting them. Please keep using that introduction."

Useful positive feedback identifies the specific behavior, its observed benefit, and what should continue. This makes the feedback actionable and reinforces a repeatable communication practice. General praise or comparisons with coworkers give less information about what the person did well.

Q04 | Correct answer: C

The patient reports feeling feverish last night; no temperature was measured. The patient requests a nurse callback.

The message preserves the reported sensation while clearly stating that no measurement was obtained. A symptom report is meaningful even when an objective value is unavailable. The assistant should neither create a measured fever nor infer that the patient's temperature later returned to normal.

Q05 | Correct answer: A

"I can tell this is worrying. The provider can explain the report; I will let them know you want to talk."

The response acknowledges the patient's emotion without inventing reassurance or interpreting the report. It also offers a concrete action within the assistant's role: alerting the provider to the patient's request. The timing of an office call does not establish a report's clinical meaning.

Q06 | Correct answer: B

"Are you in the clinic app or a web browser, and what words or buttons do you see now?"

Identifying the interface and visible controls lets the assistant choose the appropriate approved guide. The scenario has not established that the application is broken or that the patient is using a particular interface. Guessing at controls or beginning with a reinstall can add confusion before the starting point is understood.

Q07 | Correct answer: A

Offer the quieter room and explain how staff will let River know when it is time for the visit.

The available room addresses the specific environmental barriers River identified, and the notification plan preserves access to the visit. The assistant should respond to expressed needs rather than infer a diagnosis. Increasing volume or relying on an announcement that may not be heard does not provide a complete solution.

Q08 | Correct answer: C

"I am sorry I gave you the wrong directions. I have confirmed the correct room and can walk there with you now."

The response acknowledges the assistant's known error and offers an available action that resolves the immediate problem. It avoids making the patient responsible for an incorrect instruction. Inventing an assignment change or merely repeating directions does less to repair the service failure and rebuild confidence.

Q09 | Correct answer: D

"Your visit is Tuesday, November 17, 2026, at 2:00 p.m. Eastern Time at our Pine Street office."

An explicit calendar date, time, time zone, and location remain clear even if the patient reads the message later. Relative wording such as next Tuesday and assumed knowledge such as usual office can be interpreted differently. The revision communicates the confirmed appointment rather than requiring the patient to reconstruct missing details.

Q10 | Correct answer: B

"We can pause for a few minutes. I will let the team know and check back with you shortly."

The requested pause is feasible under the supplied workflow and does not conflict with an urgent need. Acknowledging it and informing the team respects the patient's preference while keeping the visit coordinated. The patient does not need to justify the tradition, and requesting a pause does not mean refusing care.

Q11 | Correct answer: B

"I am stepping out now to notify the provider. I will identify myself when I return."

A direct verbal announcement provides the information the patient requested instead of requiring inference from sounds. Identifying oneself on return continues the same agreed approach, and other entering staff should also identify themselves. The patient's request concerns awareness of presence, not physical guidance to another location.

Q12 | Correct answer: D

State that the call is ending, disconnect, document the behavior objectively, and notify the supervisor.

The caller has continued the behavior after the policy-required warning, so the next specified step is to end the call and report it through the designated process. Objective documentation and supervisor notification support follow-up without requiring the assistant to continue accepting abuse. An unexplained transfer exposes another staff member to the same behavior and does not resolve the boundary issue.

End of Practice Exam